

raised by Bacon and the other law officers of the crown, were trumpery in the extreme; and Coke's brother lawyers, who knew the depth of his researches, and the industry with which he explored every theme he undertook, could have no other feelings than those of dislike to such an employment.

Coke had long before this received his dismissal from the court of King's Bench. The supersedeas suspending him from his office was dated on the 16th of November, 1616, and it thus tersely expressed the royal pleasure:

"For certain causes now moving us, we will that you shall be no longer our chief justice to hold the pleas before us, and we command you, that you no longer interfere in that office, and by virtue of this presence, we at once remove and exonerate you from this office."*

This warrant, there is no doubt, had been for some time expected by Sir Edward Coke. He knew the power of removal possessed by the King, was fully aware of his displeasure, and that he had taken no steps to avert his indignation. He had, therefore, in preparing himself for the worst, nobly resolved to lose his seat on the bench rather than part with his integrity.

* Harleian MSS.